



▲ PAN-AFRICANISM

In the early 20th century, a worldwide movement promoting solidarity between African people began. It aimed to strengthen the cultural bonds between people of African origin. Ghana's first prime minister, Kwame Nkrumah (above), was a firm supporter of the Pan-African movement and advocated for the unity of all Africans.

Independent Africa

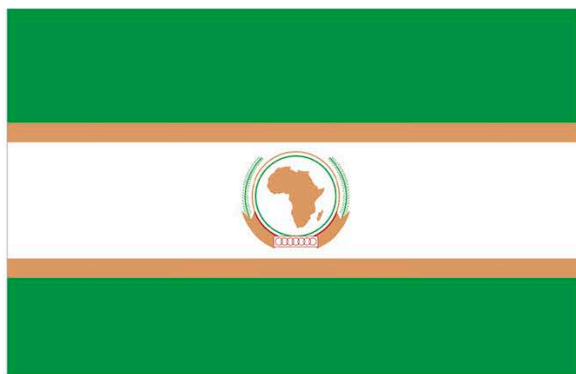
During the 1950s and 1960s, most African nations gained independence from their European colonial rulers. Freedom brought hope and opportunity, though many countries had to tackle the problems left behind by years of colonial rule. In the 21st century, however, many nations are experiencing economic growth and stability.

Colonization by European powers, who had looted the continent's wealth and natural resources, and imposed their own culture on the population, left some of the newly independent nations of Africa ill-equipped to face the challenges of independence.

In some countries, dictators took control and refused to give up their power. Many governments struggled with civil wars and conflicts between different cultures and ethnic groups. Natural disasters such as droughts ravaged some parts of the continent

and left millions of people hungry and poor. In South Africa, the government started a system known as apartheid (see pp.202–203), where Black people faced discrimination.

Despite this, many nations have achieved some stability in the 21st century. Countries such as Ghana and Nigeria have relied on their vast reserves of mineral resources, such as gold, diamonds, and oil, to boost their economies, while there are a growing number of countries with stable, democratic governments.



◀ ORGANIZATION OF AFRICAN UNITY

After gaining independence from European countries, 32 African nations established the Organization for African Unity (OAU) in 1963. The aim of the OAU was to encourage cooperation between all African countries. The OAU was replaced by the African Union in 2002.

POST-COLONIAL CONFLICTS

1975–2002

After gaining independence, Angola is caught up in a violent civil war that lasts 26 years—one of the longest civil wars in history.

1994

In Rwanda, more than 800,000 Tutsi people are killed by the Hutu people in just 100 days. The Hutu government orders the slaughter.

1983–2005

Rebel groups and the Sudanese government fight against each other in a brutal civil war that ravages the country for 22 years.

2011

The Libyan Civil War erupts between Muammar Gaddafi's government and opposing rebel groups. Gaddafi is eventually overthrown.